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Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Leman Academy of Excellence: Parker-Stroh

School Website: <https://lemanacademy.com/schools/colorado/parker-stroh-k-8/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Leman Academy of Excellence – Parker Stroh (Colorado, 80134) presents as a public charter K–8 that explicitly identifies itself as offering a tuition-free classical education built on a foundation of wisdom and virtue. Public-facing materials emphasize a classical orientation, small-class benefits, and a strong partnership with families. The school clearly communicates goals around character formation and virtuous learning, while highlighting parent involvement and a supportive community. However, while the school markets itself as classical and uses language aligned with classical education, public materials do not consistently detail core classical curricular components (e.g., grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books) or explicit Socratic pedagogy in the K–8 context. Pedagogical specifics such as cycles of memorization/recitation, Socratic discussion, or explicit liturgical/community practices are not prominently evidenced in the public content available from the crawl.

Overall classification (aggregate): SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Key takeaways:

- Strong signals of classical branding and virtue-oriented aims (e.g., “classical education,” “foundation of wisdom and virtue”) with explicit emphasis on parental partnership and community (cited evidence).
- Explicit, named classical curriculum components (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books; deep history) are not clearly stated in the publicly crawled materials, suggesting only partial alignment with the full classical curriculum rubric.
- Parent engagement and community orientation are pronounced (positive alignment with Six Elements).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials frame the school as offering a “classical education” that builds a foundation of wisdom and virtue (explicit wording in Parker Stroh materials).
- Campus descriptions emphasize a classical foundation and a community environment that supports character development.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: virtue, wisdom (explicitly shown in the school’s value propositions).
- Negative keywords present: none detected in the public content reviewed (e.g., no explicit secular-relativist signaling).
- Why this rating
- The school communicates a virtue-centric orientation consistent with the “Religious and Metaphysical Foundations” axis, but it does not publicly articulate theology, liturgical practices, or explicitly metaphysical theological commitments in the crawled content. The lexicon identifies truth/goodness/beauty, virtue, and wonder as signals; the site shows virtue and wisdom but not the full theological-liturgical program. This yields a clear but partial alignment, hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Lexicon context: virtue and wisdom are strong positive signals in this category; absence of explicit theology or liturgical practice reduces to partial alignment. See the classical-lexicon mapping for context.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school states it offers a K–8 “tuition-free classical education” and emphasizes character formation (virtue) and wisdom as foundational goals. This aligns with formation-oriented aims rather than purely vocational targets.
- The campus narrative stresses character development, knowledge, and the aim of forming students for life, not merely job readiness.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation (implied by “foundation of wisdom and virtue”), virtue, wisdom.
- Negative keywords present: none observed (no explicit workforce-preparation framing).
- Why this rating
- The school’s public materials foreground formation, virtue, and wisdom as primary aims rather than immediate job-readiness or 21st-century-skills framing. This maps strongly to the classical category’s emphasis on formation and the pursuit of the true, good, and beautiful. Given the emphasis on formation and classical aims, CLASSICAL is justified, though explicit Great Books/paideia-language is not spelled out in the crawl.
- Lexicon anchors: formation, virtue, wisdom, Great Conversation (where applicable) in classical pedagogy. See lexicon mapping for context.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site identifies the program as “tuition-free classical education” with a “classical foundation,” and mentions enrichment in art, music, athletics, and after-school offerings. There is no explicit listing of grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin/Greek, or Great Books in the crawled content.
- The absence of explicit Great Books, history-focused curriculum language, or threefold classical discipline (grammar/logic/rhetoric) in public-facing text reduces clear alignment with the full Curriculum signals.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: classical education (explicit), foundation (as a curricular framing). Virtue/wisdom are thematic (category 3 treats content signals; exact terms limited here).
- Negative keywords present: lack of explicit grammar/logic/rhetoric; absence of Great Books; no explicit history-as-history framing.
- Why this rating
- The curriculum is described in broad, classical terms but without explicit articulation of the core liberal-arts triad (grammar, logic, rhetoric) or Great Books in the accessible crawl. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation, reflecting partial alignment rather than a complete, textbook-classical curriculum description.
- Lexicon alignment notes: Great Books, grammar, logic, rhetoric are core category 3 signals; not clearly evidenced in the site copy.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials mention small class sizes, a caring environment, and enrichment offerings, but do not clearly describe Socratic discussion, memory work, chanting, recitation, or scholé-style contemplative practice in the K–8 context. The absence of explicit “Socratic” or “recitation/memory” language is notable in the crawl.
- There is no explicit signaling of upper-school rhetoric training, debates, or formal scholé/restful pedagogy in the available public content.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: “classical foundation,” “small class sizes,” “enrichment” (reflecting some classical environment cues).

- Negative keywords present: explicit signals of classical pedagogy (Socratic seminars, memory work, chanting, restfulness, scholé) are not evidenced; experiential-learning dominance and project-based-only signals are not present in the crawl, but the lack of explicit traditional pedagogy signals is a negative for the Classical Pedagogy criterion. The lexicon lists these as positive signals; their absence reduces the category strength.
- Why this rating
- The absence of explicit mention of Socratic discourse, memorization/recitation, or scholé-focused teaching in the crawled content leads to NOT CLASSICAL under the Pedagogy rubric. The school's public content signals a classical branding but does not demonstrate the full pedagogy package described by the classical rubric (especially for upper-grade rhetoric, memory work, or contemplative restfulness in instruction).
- Lexicon context: Socratic pedagogy, mnemonic/recitation practices, and scholé are core signals; their absence reduces the category score.

Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site notes "our dedicated teachers and staff are committed to guiding each scholar's academic and personal growth," which is supportive but does not articulate a "living curriculum," mentor culture, or the portrait of a teacher as a model of virtue. The explicit "faculty as living curriculum" language is not visible in the crawl.
- The public copy lacks language about a "portrait of a teacher," collegial culture as a feature, or a formal classical-faculty formation program.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: "dedicated teachers and staff," "guiding scholars" (positive signals about faculty quality).
- Negative keywords present: absence of "model teachers," "living curriculum," "portrait of a teacher," or explicit faculty formation programs in the crawl. The lexicon marks those as strong positive signals for a classical faculty; their absence reduces category strength.
- Why this rating
- While the school clearly values its teachers, the lack of explicit classical-faculty descriptors (e.g., living curriculum, mentorship-centric faculty, or formal classical pedagogy training) yields a NOT CLASSICAL designation for this category in the absence of those signals in the crawled text.
- Lexicon references: model teachers, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher are classical signals; not evidenced here.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials emphasize partnerships with parents and family involvement (e.g., "They love partnering with the parents," and references to parent resources). The Parker Stroh materials repeatedly highlight home-school partnership and parent involvement as a core theme.
- The content includes parent resources, calendars, and community-focused offerings, which align with the Six Elements' emphasis on partnership with families and formation of affections via home-education alignment.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parent formation, open campus/parent involvement, co-teachers, family engagement, parental leadership. The crawl includes explicit parent-centered language and "Plan a Visit" calls.
- Negative keywords present: minimal signs of consumer-customer framing; rather, the content leans toward ongoing parental engagement and a mutual-participation model, which aligns positively with the "Partnership with Families" signals. No explicit negative signals found in the crawl.
- Why this rating

- The material clearly aligns with the classical category's emphasis on family partnership and community formation. The school presents itself as inviting parents as co-educators and hosts parent-facing materials and events. This is a strong classical signal in the Parents & Community category.
- Lexicon anchors: partnership with families, formation of affections, and cultural transmission are strong positive signals; the public materials reflect those priorities.

Aggregate Ranking (Six-Category Synthesis)

- Element 1: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- For Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations)
- More explicit articulation of theology, liturgy, or liturgical practices (even if modest) and how they integrate with core disciplines. Include statements about transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) and how these are pursued across subjects.
- For Element 2 (School Purpose and Goal)
- Strengthen explicit language around formation and human flourishing as the telos, with occasional references to Great Books or paideia-inspired aims to deepen alignment with the full classical mission.
- For Element 3 (Curriculum)
- Publicly publish explicit core-classical elements: grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Latin/Greek; and a more explicit history/Western-civilization thread across grades. This would render the curriculum more clearly "Classical" to external evaluators.
- For Element 4 (Pedagogy)
- Include explicit references to Socratic/Scholé-style pedagogy in upper grades (or clearly explain its staged implementation by grade level) and recitation/memory work where appropriate. Communicate how memory, chanting, or classical memory work fits into daily practice.
- For Element 5 (Faculty)
- Introduce a "living curriculum" concept for faculty and a formal portrait of the teacher; describe how faculty development in classical pedagogy is pursued and how teachers model virtue and learning in practice.
- For Element 6 (Parents & Community)
- Continue and expand parent formation opportunities (book studies, lectures, family catechesis, liturgical calendar alignment) and explicit pathways for parent involvement as co-educators. Ensure the school maintains open-campus norms and transparent communication.

ABSTRACT

The Parker Stroh campus of Leman Academy of Excellence presents as a public charter K–8 with a strong classical branding, centering virtue and wisdom as foundational aims. The school communicates a formation-oriented mission and explicit parental partnership, both of which align with the classical education ethos in meaningful ways. However, the publicly crawled materials lack explicit articulation of core classical curricular components (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books) and a clearly defined pedagogy (Socratic dialogue, scholé, memory-work) in the K–8 context. As such, the six-category assessment yields a mixed profile: CLASSICAL signals in School Purpose and Goal and Parents & Community, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signals in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and Curriculum, but NOT CLASSICAL signals in Pedagogy and Faculty. The aggregate classification is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Six-Element Keyword Crosswalk (high-level)

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: Evidence of virtue and wisdom emphasis; limited explicit theology or liturgical practices in crawl data. Positive indicators anchored by virtue/wisdom; absence of explicit theological-liturgical signaling. See sources describing Leman Parker Stroh's classical framing.
- School Purpose and Goal: Formation and wisdom-oriented aims are foregrounded; job-prep framing is not emphasized in public content. CLASSICAL alignment supported by virtue/wisdom formation language.
- Curriculum: Classical branding present; explicit Great Books/grammar-logic-rhetoric components are not clearly described in crawled content. SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL due to partial alignment.
- Pedagogy: Pedagogical method signals are not explicit; lack of documented Socratic/Scholet-style practices in the crawl. NOT CLASSICAL based on the evidence.
- Faculty: Public-facing content emphasizes dedicated teachers but lacks explicit "living curriculum" or classical-faculty formation language. NOT CLASSICAL by the current evidence.
- Parents & Community: Strong alignment with partnership with families, parent formation, and open community involvement. CLASSICAL signals present.

Notes on methodology and sources

- The analysis integrates two data sources: (1) school-specific crawl content (public-facing materials from the Parker Stroh campus) for keyword/signaling evidence, and (2) the knowledge-base classical-school rubric and lexicon (Six Essential Elements and classicality lexicon) to map signals to Positive/Negative keyword indicators and scoring rubric. Key school-crawl evidence includes statements about "tuition-free classical education," "foundation of wisdom and virtue," "classical foundation," and explicit parent-partnership language.
- The classical rubric and lexicon provide the framework for keyword signal mapping: Positive keywords include concepts like truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, formation, great books, memory-work, scholé, and partnership with families; negative signals include lack of these elements or presence of non-classical approaches. See the lexicon and "Six Essential Elements" resources for context.

End of report.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
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